

March Madness Bracket — Scoring & Rules

Overview

Welcome to our class March Madness bracket challenge! Points are awarded by round, with an **extra upset bonus in Round 1**.

Scoring by Round

- **Round 1 (64 teams):** 1 point per correct pick
 - **Upset bonus:** +1 extra point *in Round 1 only* for correctly picking an upset where the **lower seed beats the higher seed, excluding 8 vs. 9 games**.
- **Round 2 (32 teams):** 2 points per correct pick
- **Round 3 — Sweet 16:** 3 points per correct pick
- **Round 4 — Elite Eight:** 4 points per correct pick
- **Round 5 — Final Four:** 5 points per correct pick
- **Round 6 — National Championship:** 6 points per correct pick

“Third round = 3 points” and so on—i.e., the point value increases by 1 each round.

Upset Definition (Round 1 only)

- An **upset** is when the **numerically larger seed** defeats the **numerically smaller seed** (e.g., a 12 beats a 5).
 - **No upset credit** for 8 vs. 9 matchups.
 - Each correctly predicted eligible upset in **Round 1** earns **+1 extra point**.
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Quick Examples

Example A — Round 1 upset you called correctly

- You picked a **12** to beat a **5**, and it happened.
- Points: **1 (correct pick) + 1 (upset bonus) = 2 points**

Example B — Round 1 correct pick that is not an upset

- You picked a **2** to beat a **15**, and it happened.
- Points: **1 point** (no upset bonus)

Example C — Sweet 16 correct pick

- You picked the winner of a Sweet 16 game correctly.
 - Points: **3 points**
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Bonus Points

- **Beat-the-Instructor Bonus:** If your total score **beats my score**, you earn **+1 bonus point**.
 - **Placement Bonuses (class leaderboard):**
 - **1st place:** +5
 - **2nd place:** +4
 - **3rd place:** +3
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